

Review Writing Example 1



The Odds are Ever in Your Favour

I imagine a world where you have to fight to exist, where living is a privilege for many and sacrifice is an annual event. That's the world that director Gary Ross has brought to life in the epic dystopian film *The Hunger Games*. Critics are calling this film a 'cinematic success', promising that audiences will be 'hungry for more games' after watching the three-hour film and it's easy to believe when the film made an impressive \$155 million in its opening weekend. So what is it that has made audiences devour this film?

The Hunger Games, an adaptation of the first in a trilogy of fantasy books aimed at younger readers by Suzanne Collins, follows Katniss Everdeen (Jennifer Lawrence) in a world of 12 districts of a post-apocalyptic nation called Panem. Each year, children from each

district are pitted against each other in a state-sponsored fight to the death. This year, Katniss' sister, Primrose (Willow Shields), is the unlucky girl selected, but Katniss, a feisty and brave heroine, volunteers to take the place of her sister and enter the Hunger Games, a digitally-created world of fear, torture and control where death lurks around every corner and there can only be one survivor...

It's Jennifer Lawrence's performance that takes centre stage. As the main character of the film, she is spirited, resourceful and courageous, giving an emotional realism to her character that upstages everyone else in the film. This is Lawrence's first major Hollywood role and she has entirely done it justice, giving a shove to feminism and female strength in a role that is challenging and passionate in equal measure.

This strong feminine role is contrasted by her male counterpart, Peeta (Josh Hutcherson) who is an unlikeable wimp. You can imagine he cries every time he gets a paper cut and Katniss becomes responsible for his safety as well as her own when they find themselves within the Hunger Games. Luckily, Gale (Liam Hemsworth), Katniss' best friend, is able to uphold the stereotype of the strong, capable and dependable male that we have come to expect from a Hollywood blockbuster.

Dynamic, clever and edge-of-your-seat engaging, this is set to be the film of the year and, with the other two parts of the trilogy already in production, this is one film you'll want to get your teeth into straight away and savour.

Rating: ★★★★★

